

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A snapshot of Moscow's history.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know anything about Russian history?
- Do you know who Lenin was and why he was very important in Russia and all over the world?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a small paragraph.
- I can talk or report about things, actions and events.
- I can write about history.





Let's Explore!

Sally decides go to a reading at the Moscow Playhouse. Listen to the actor share an **excerpt*** from the book *The 1917 Revolution*.

* An "excerpt" is a small portion.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

In November 1917, a communist government came to power in Russia. Its leader, Lenin, was very popular with workers with slogans like, "Peace, bread and land". His time in prison for his beliefs made him a legitimate leader of the average worker. First, Lenin promised the people of Russia that he would take Russia out of World War I. He also said he would give land to the peasants. Finally, he ordered that Soviets and workers would control the factories. The support for Lenin grew in a country that had been controlled by tsars and outsiders. Overall, they believed that under communist leadership, the lives of the Russian people would be easier.





Let's Practice!

Do you know how to organize a paragraph?

Instructions: Reorganize the sentences to put them in the correct order.

1. In November 1917, a communist government came to power in Russia.
2. The support for Lenin grew in a country that had been controlled by tsars and outsiders.
3. First, Lenin promised the people of Russia that he would take Russia out of World War I.
4. Finally, he ordered that Soviets and workers would control the factories.
5. Its leader, Lenin, was very popular with workers with slogans like, "Peace, bread and land."
6. Overall, they believed that under communist leadership, the lives of Russian people would be easier.
7. He also said he would give land to the peasants.



Let's Practice!

What did Lenin promise the people of Russia?

Instructions: Draw a line from the statement on the left to the response on the right.

Its leader, Lenin, was very popular with workers with slogans like, "Peace, bread and land."

strong beliefs

His time in prison for his beliefs made him a legitimate leader of the average worker.

peasants received land

First, Lenin promised the people of Russia that he would take Russia out of World War I.

Soviets control factories

He also said he would give land to the peasants.

slogans of unity

Finally, he ordered that Soviets and workers would control the factories.

removal from war





Extension Activity

Research a historical event in another town, city or country.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research an interesting festival or cultural celebration.
- Write a paragraph.
- Use the Past Simple tense.
- Read your paragraph to a partner or family member.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research festivals and cultural celebrations.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph.

☐ ☐

I use the Simple Past tense.

☐ ☐

I read the paragraph aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **communist** (noun): a person who believes in communism or is a member of a political party that supports communism
e.g. The Communist Party came to power in 1917.
- **slogan** (noun): a word or phrase that is easy to remember and is used by a group to attract attention
e.g. Lenin's slogans were popular with workers.
- **legitimate** (adjective): real, accepted, or official
e.g. They believed Lenin was the legitimate leader of the workers in the Soviet Union.
- **peasant** (noun): a poor farmer or farm worker
e.g. He also said he would give land to the peasants.
- **Soviet** (noun): person from the former USSR
e.g. He ordered that Soviets and workers would control the factories.
- **factory** (noun): a building or group of buildings where products are made
e.g. There is a factory in that small town.
- **outsider** (noun): a person who does not belong to or is not accepted into a particular group or organization
e.g. The support for Lenin grew in a country that had been controlled by tsars and outsiders.





Learning Points

Writing About History and The *Simple Past* Tense

Writing about history requires you to include a lot of details and historical information. Writing about history shows your writing skills and your understanding of information.

1. Research information about a topic. Use more than one source.
2. Stay on topic. When you write about history, include events and issues, not descriptions.
3. Include the important details.
4. Do not include your opinion. The paragraph is on history not your opinion of it.
5. Write in chronological order.
6. Write in the past tense.

When you talk about history, you usually use the *Simple Past* tense because you are talking about things in general and/or facts in the past.

When you write about the past you can both regular and irregular past tense verbs.

Verbs with a regular past tense:

Base Verb	Past Verb
promise	promised
order	ordered
believe	believed

Verbs with an irregular past tense:

Base Verb	Past Verb
come	came
am/is/are	was/were
make	made
grow	grew

Examples:

- *Overall, they believed that under communist leadership, the lives of the Russian people would be easier.*
- *In November 1917, a communist government came to power in Russia.*
- *Lenin was very popular with workers.*

